The Technique > The High-Rise Pancake

Four ingredients is all it takes to elevate your morning routine

A German pancake isn't really a pancake. It's more like a soufflé. Or maybe a popover. Or a Yorkshire pudding. The point is, when it's in the oven baking (no, this isn't a stovetop thing), it puffs up—and *keeps* puffing up, to the point that you think: Wait a minute, did I really have a hand in making this thing? Am I suddenly a real cook?

It's a dish that's shockingly easy to prepare. As in, you're hungover and brain-dead on a lazy holiday weekend and you can *still* make it. Beat together flour, eggs, and milk; stick pan in oven to melt butter; pour batter; stick back in oven. And that's it. Really.

The effect is showstopping, the aroma escaping the oven intoxicating, the look boggling. (No whipped egg whites necessary.) And most important, it tastes phenomenal—buttery, fluffy, eggy, with a tinge of browned crustiness. You will eat an entire one yourself. Trust me.

Growing up, I thought my mom was the only mother in America who made "the Big Pancake." I'd get giddy when she'd pull out the Pyrex pie plate and throw in a huge hunk of butter. I eventually learned that she had clipped the recipe decades earlier from *The New York Times*, that sometimes it's called a Dutch Baby, and that you can find it occasionally at the odd pancake house. Of course, my 3-year-old son, Marlon, knows none of this. This holiday season I'm going to introduce him to the Big Pancake, and I'm pretty sure it's going to blow his mind.

—ADAM RAPOPORT

The Big Pancake

3 tablespoons butter
2 eggs, beaten
½ cup flour
½ cup milk
1 teaspoon sugar
¼ teaspoon salt
(Pinch of ground nutmeg, if you've got it)

For garnish:
Juice of 1 lemon
Powdered sugar

Direction

1> Preheat the oven to 425 degrees.
2> Put the butter in a 9- or 10-inch pie plate or ovenproof skillet. Place in oven, then remove once butter is melted.
3> Mix the remaining ingredients together with a whisk and pour into the hot skillet. Immediately return it to the oven and bake for 18 *to* 20 minutes *till* puffy and evenly browned on the outside.
4> Remove. Sprinkle with the lemon juice and powdered sugar. Slice and serve immediately.



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